NUS National University of Singapore | Industry Liaison Office

GRIP Pitching Training – Kick Off

Pitching Task Force

NUS GRIP
GRADUATE RESEARCH INNOVATION PROGRAMME

GRIP Pitching Training –

:

4:00pm – 5:00pm

- Schedule for Pitching Preparation -
- Fundraising 101 -
- Pitching Fundamentals - Jack
- Pitch (templates & examples) –

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Jack So

- Founder & CEO Accelerators & Mentorship
- Partner at boutique consultancy partnership for fundraising & BD

- Physician / Entrepreneur
- Corporate VC
- Competitive Strategy Expert

- Founder / Entrepreneur
- Investor
- Honorary Ambassador (Wayne, Michigan, USA)

Key Dates

No.	Session name	Date	Teams
1	R4 Consultation #7 (review pitching process and story boarding)	Tue, 3 Nov	All
2	R4 Consultation #8, Pitch review 1/3 (storyboarding and gaps)	Thu, 5 Nov	1/3 teams
2	R4 Consultation #8, Pitch review 2/3 (storyboarding and gaps)	Fri, 6 Nov	1/3 teams
2	R4 Consultation #8, Pitch review 3/3 (storyboarding and gaps)	Fri, 13 Nov	1/3 teams
3	Pitch training 1	Tue, 17 Nov	All
4	Pitch training 2	Fri, 20 Nov	All
5	Full Dress Rehearsal 2 (final changes/readiness for Inv. Panel)	Mon, 23 Nov	Group 1
5	Full Dress Rehearsal 2 (final changes/readiness for Inv. Panel)	Tue, 24 Nov	Group 2
6	Full Dress Rehearsal 3	Fri, 27 Nov (submit FINAL PPT by 6pm)	All (optional)

Key Dates

No.	Session name	Date	Teams
	Investment Panel 1	Tue, 1 Dec	Group 1
7	Pitch review Lift off day 1/2 for Group 1 (story update and time reduction)	Thu, 3 Dec	Group 1
	Investment Panel 2	Fri, 4 Dec	Group 2
7	Pitch review Lift off day 2/2 for Group 2 (storyboarding and gaps)	Mon, 7 Dec	Group 2
8	Full Dress Rehearsal 3	Tue, 8 Dec	All
	Lift Off Day	Thu, 10 Dec	All

Look out for further information from GRIP Admin

Stay Updated on the latest with with the GRIP Hub

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Fund Raising 101: Makings of an Investible Business

[redacted] GURNANI, MD MBA MS

Associate Director, [redacted]

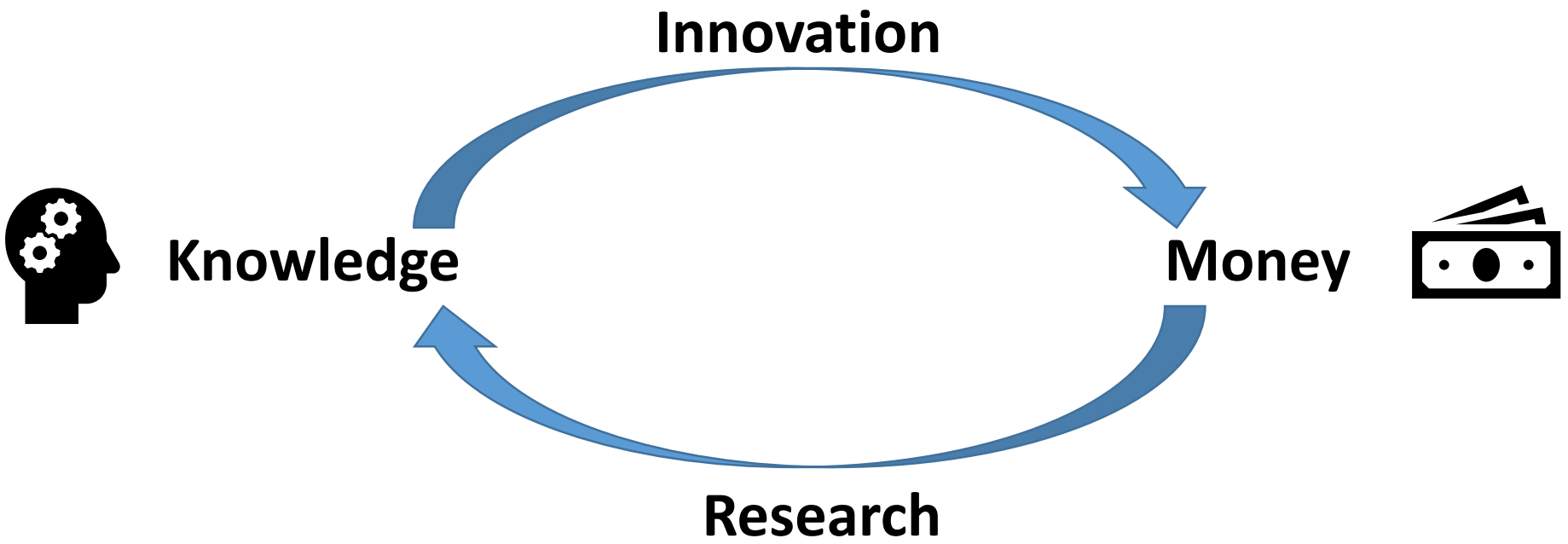
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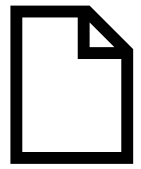
These are a few tips based on our experience to provide guidance. Practice these and make your own list on what works for you!

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Research vs Innovation



- , 3M,
Inventor of the Post-It note



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Why Fund Raise?

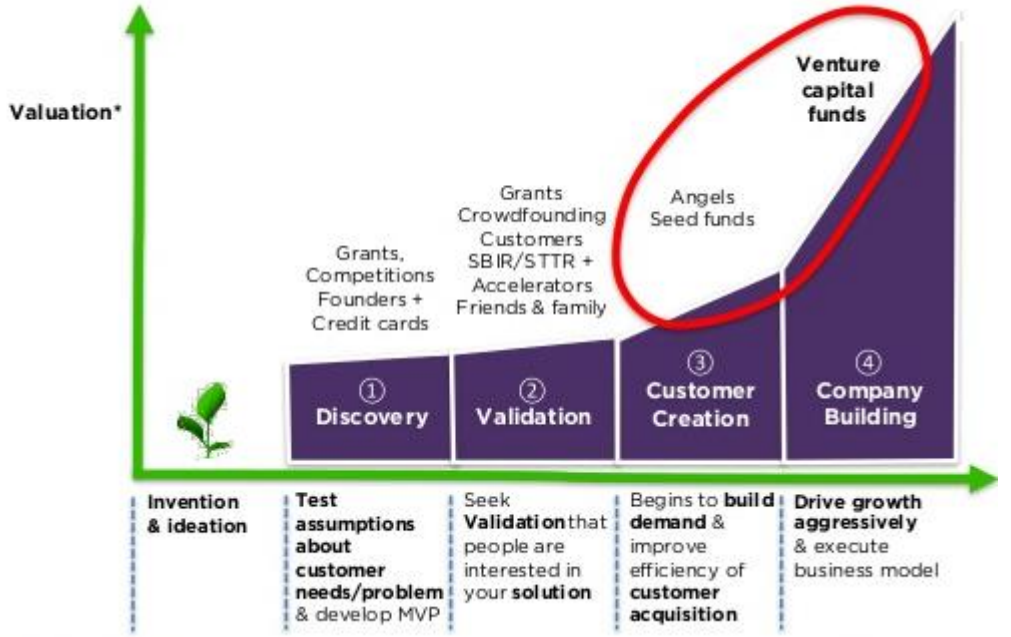
: How much is an Idea worth?

Invention and Ideation is the first step

Converting your idea to innovation will need funding

Funding is like Oxygen for your start-up.

PS: if you find someone who pays for ideas, please refer them to me ☺



What's your start-ups valuation?
Build your own Valuation Ladder

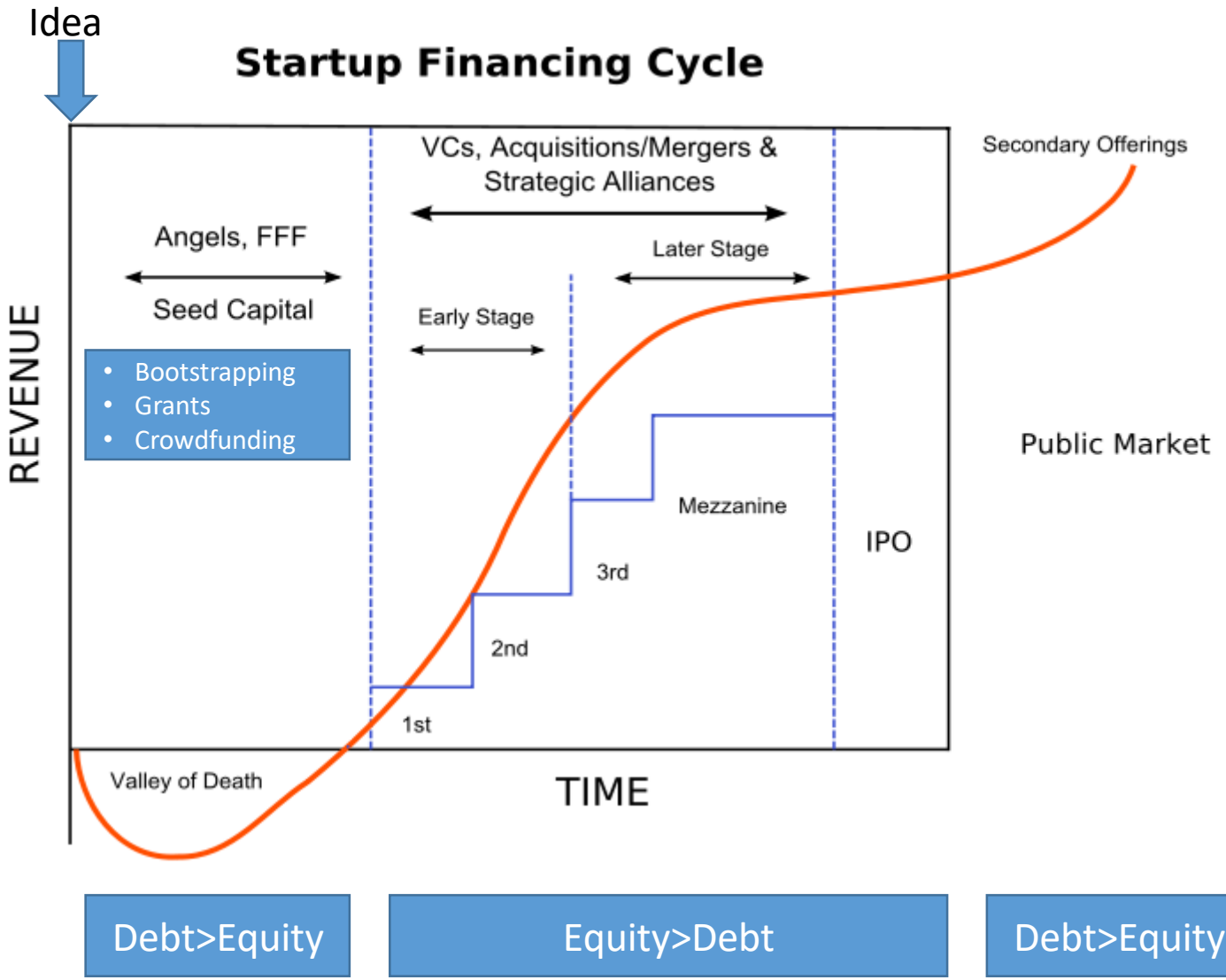
Image Source: NYU Entrepreneurial Institute

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Generic Start-Up Funding needs

Sources of Capital:

1. Revenue – preferred
2. "*Free*" – Grants, crowdfunding, bootstrapping (limited quantum, gated, time-consuming)
3. Debt – non-dilutive (obligatory)
4. Equity/ownership – Dilutive (lose of control)



At each stage, know who you are and who you are looking for!

Image Source: NYU Entrepreneurial Institute

Guidance only.
Financing Cycle varies by industry /market type.

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Generic Start-Up Funding needs

: Is there something called “Bad Money”

Yes! Apart from illegal sources of capital, you don’t want to get involved with someone who is more trouble than they are worth!

- do they “get” you?
- do they know what it takes to succeed in your industry/market
- is it really difficult to keep them interested?

It is worth time and effort to keep your grants and public funding proposal pipeline full at each stage

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Fundraising Best practices

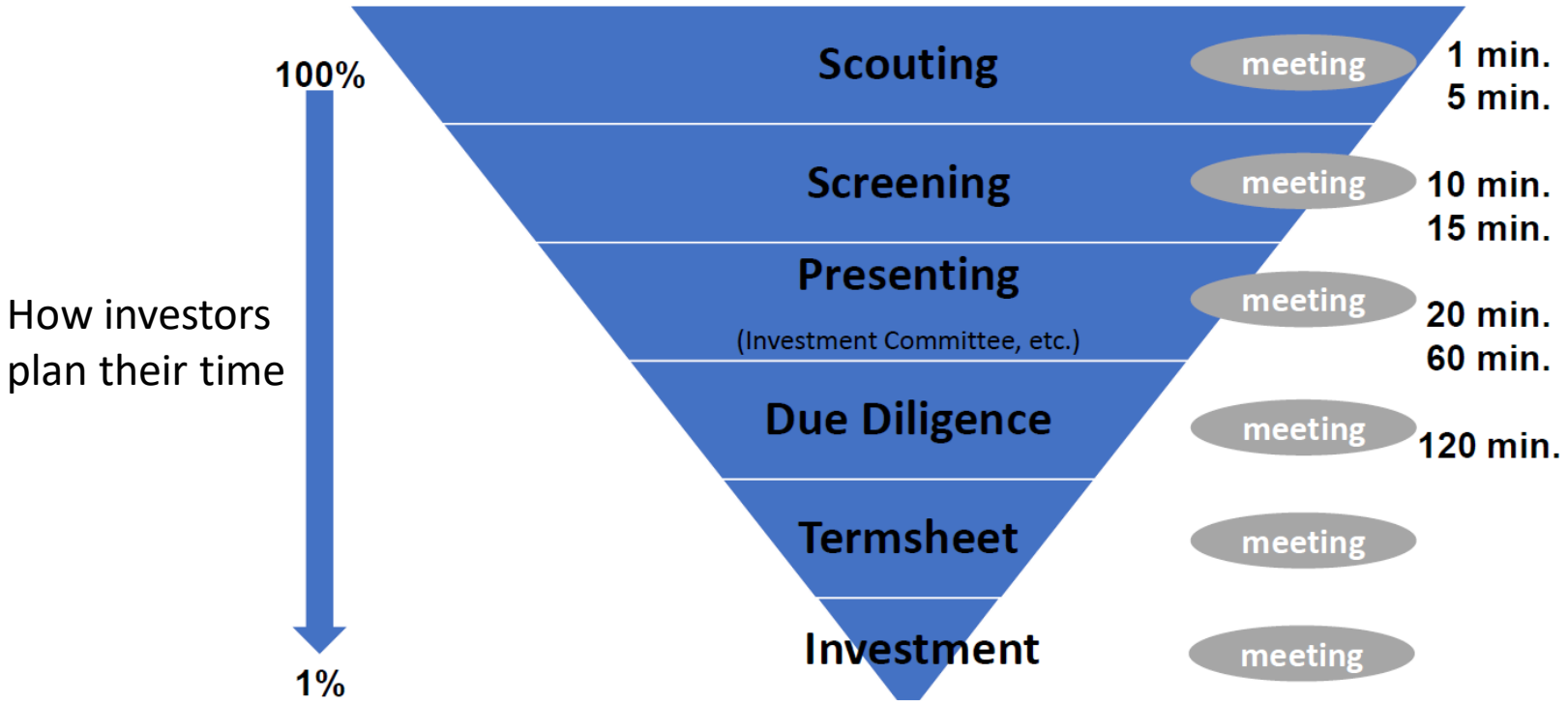
Fundraising is a Contact Sport!

0. **Start early** – it is about people/relationships, human chemistry & takes time
1. **Anticipate** – Pace/plan your activities, identify your financing needs/gaps, develop your valuation ladder, approach investors **only** when you are ready!
2. **Prepare** – your pitch/documentation, Elevator>Exec summary>Presentation deck>Detailed data room> Business Plan (more on this later)
3. **Identify** – funding sources and their details – for VCs create **your** list with details – Contact person, Stage, , Timing, Portfolio, Word of mouth
4. **Connect** – get personal referrals/warm intro through your network, portfolio, mentors, advisors, current portfolio, other investors, service providers, LinkedIn etc.
5. **Kaizen** – take feedback and continuously improve your pitch/documentation
6. **Momentum** – when ready, generate buzz/visibility, reach out to your list of investors and try to secure more than one termsheets to compare.

Raise money and then go back to business. Rinse & Repeat

What is the objective of securing a investor meeting?

To secure a second meeting!



Meeting Best Practices:

1. Agree on agenda/objective
2. Know the attendees beforehand
3. Understand/Listen first
4. Speak Up
5. Check for questions
6. Take copious notes during meeting
7. Circulate actionable meeting notes
8. Remember to Follow-up

It takes many meetings to secure an investment,
So, ABC – Always Be Closing!

Image Source: CIMIT, Boston

Check the stage of the VC lifecycle – the closer you are to the beginning of the fund lifecycle, the more likely you are to get a deal.

1. Early stage VCs typically look for :
   a. **Team, they invest in you!**
   b. Technology/application
   c. Traction
2. VCs work for their investors not for you -> so don't take them personally
3. If a VC firm is interested, plan to spend a lot of time with them
   - Show your passion, take feedback, but don't get intimidated
4. VCs are human, tell them a story, bring them with you on a journey!

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One key takeaway

Investors are humans, tell them a story

Bring them with you on your journey!

Idea → Invention

Invention →Product

Product → Business

Business → Pitch

Pitch → Investment

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